A-A-51712A
4 May 1988
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0051712(DM)
9 October 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TONGS, SKULL TRACTION GARDNER-WELLS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers skull tongs of the Gardner-Wells design suitable for traction and/or immobilization of the cervical spine.

Salient characteristics:

Style and design. The style shall be that of a half circle bar to partially encompass the head. One end of the bar shall have a spring loaded point for insertion into the skull. Screws shall have sharp needle points. The points shall have a small diameter hollow rod for protection, and in their maximum open position shall be 6-1/4 inches (16 cm). The design and dimensions shall comply with Figure 1.

Securely attached to the bar shall be an S-shaped hook plate for the attachment of weights. The plate shall be legibly marked with instructions for antiseptic wipe of both screws and skull. The plate shall also be marked to tighten the screws until the proper set force exists. The screws shall have a means of locking them in the set position.

Material. The complete instrument shall be manufactured from Class 1 austenitic corrosion-resisting steel as specified in American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Designation F899.

Hardness. The complete instrument shall be properly passivated and have a hardness range of Rockwell (HRB) 75 to 100.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Finish. The instrument shall have a mirror or satin finish. Screws shall have knurled handles.

Passivation. The complete tong assembly shall be passivated after completion of all fabricating and finishing operations.

Corrosion resistance. The tong assembly shall show no signs of corrosion or plating or copper when tested for corrosion resistance as specified ASTM Designation 1089.

Screws and locking mechanism. The screws and locking device shall turn with a smooth and equal resistance to facilitate care of operation.

Identification markings. The tongs shall bear the contractor's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Retractors of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of origin.

Workmanship. The entire instrument shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One skull tongs, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and Table I. The unit of product for sampling purposes shall be one tong assembly.

TABLE I.

Type of defects	Inspection Level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	4.0

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Tong assembly not free from cracks, pits, burs, sharp edges, scale, rough areas or corrosion.
102	Finish of the tong assembly not as specified.
103	Screws and locking device do not turn with a smooth and equal resistance.
104	Style and design not as specified.
Minor	
201	Identification markings not present, not complete, not correct, or not legible.

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Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified below. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one tong assembly.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedures	Inspection Level	AQL
Composition Analysis	ASTM F899	Require ments		0.0
Hardness Test	HRB 75-100	ASTM E18 E92 E140	S-2	1.5
Dimensions	Figure 1	-----	S-1	2.5
Copper Sulfate test	ASTM 1089	ASTM 1089	S-2	1.0
Boil test	ASTM 1089	ASTM 1089	S-2	1.0

Tests.

Corrosion resistance. The tongs shall be tested as specified in ASTM Designation 1089.

Hardness. Hardness shall be tested in accordance with ASTM E18 or E92 whichever is applicable. Conversion of hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM E140.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-125-6616	TONGS, SKULL TRACTION, (Gardner-Wells)

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

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CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PBS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4064

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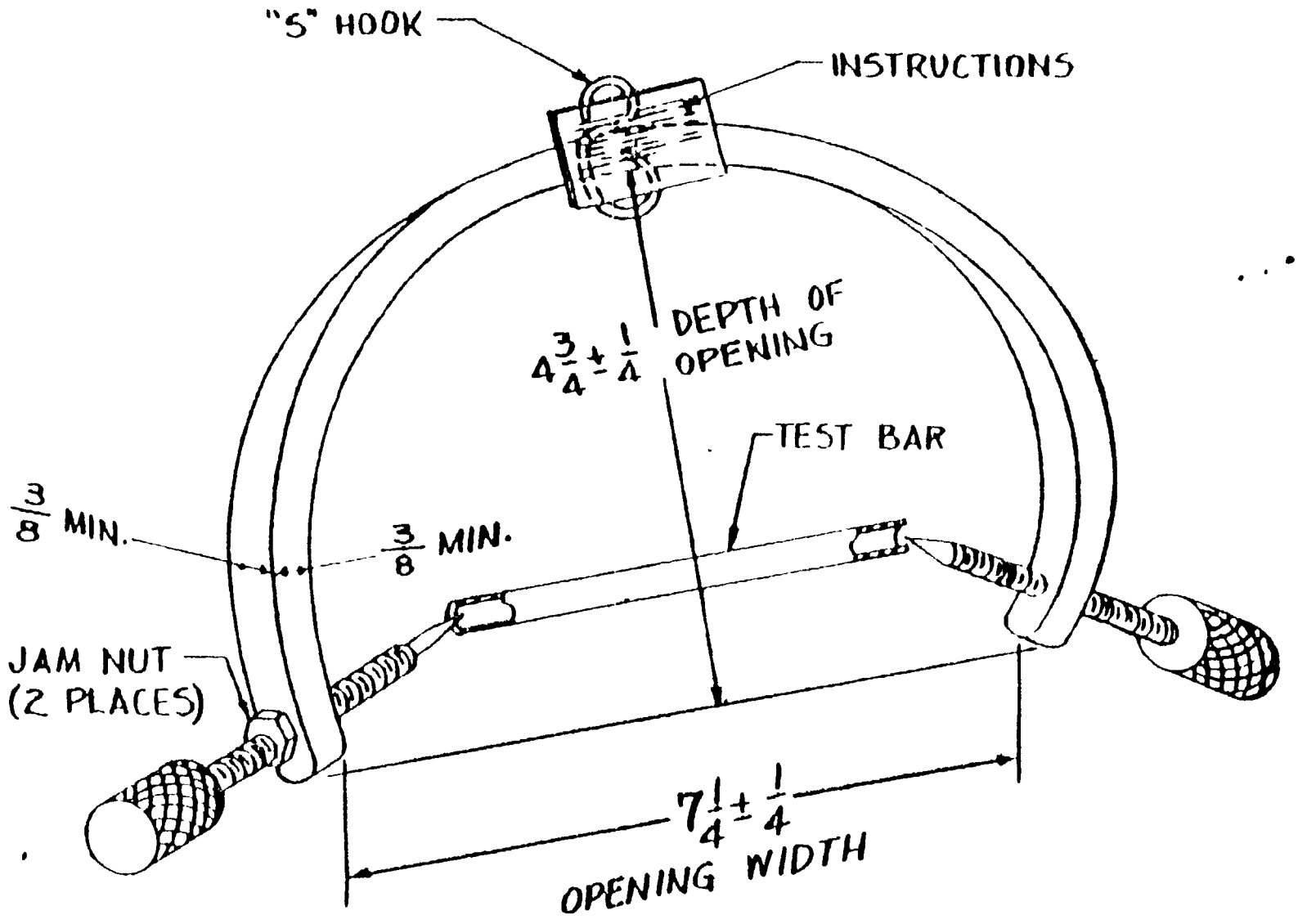


FIGURE 1. TONGS, SKULL TRACTION

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions - Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51712A	TONGS, SKULL TRACTION GARDNER-WELLS

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
3b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording.

b. Recommended Wording.

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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